

Uses



Common salt

Edible salt is made by refining the mineral halite.



Mummy

This mummified body, or mummy, was preserved using sodium compounds.

Sodium fireworks



Bright yellow lights in fireworks get their colour from burning sodium compounds.



Indigo dyes – often used in blue jeans – contain sodium.



Indigo dye powder

Spraying salt keeps roads free from ice and frost.

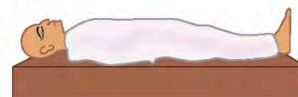


MUMMIFICATION

Ancient Egyptians believed in life after death and so preserved the bodies of their dead. A dead body was washed and the organs removed, then crystals of sodium compounds were used to dry it out. Finally, the body was wrapped, which completed the process of mummification.



1. Organs, such as the stomach and lungs, were removed from the dead body.

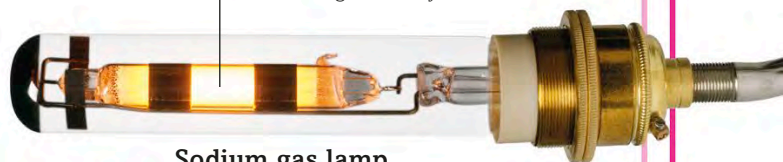


2. Sodium compounds were spread over the body to dry it.



3. The body was wrapped in cloth to mummify it.

This tube glows bright yellow-orange when sodium gas is electrified.



Sodium gas lamp

Cats were sacred in ancient Egypt, so their bodies were mummified.

Bar of soap



Some soaps contain sodium hydroxide.

Baking soda



Odourless white powder



De-icing

into flames when in contact with water. Sodium compounds in **fireworks** burn with a yellow-orange colour. In ancient Egypt, crystals of sodium compounds were used to preserve dead bodies as **mummies**. Another useful compound is sodium bicarbonate, or **baking soda**, which makes dough

rise by releasing bubbles of carbon dioxide. When refined, sodium chloride, or **common salt**, has several uses. It makes ice melt so it is used in salty grit added to slippery, frozen roads. This helps **de-ice** them to make them safer. It is also an important seasoning for meals.